

INITIATE:

Team Approach to Foundational Interventions



JAMES CARTER, MD

APPLYING FUNCTIONAL MEDICINE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE

Disclosures

James Carter MD disclosed no relevant financial relationships with ineligible companies.

Unless otherwise noted, all stock photos in this presentation are used with permission by 123RF.com.

Learning Objectives

At the conclusion of this segment, successful participants will be able to:

1. Explain best practices for referring and collaborating with other practitioners in urgent and non-urgent cases.
2. Explain the role of judicious use of laboratory testing in functional medicine practice.

IFM Clinical Skills and Performance Objectives

THIS SEGMENT WILL ENABLE PARTICIPANTS TO DEVELOP & APPLY THESE SKILLS IN THEIR PRACTICE:

1. Identify and refer patients with “red flag” conditions to urgent/specialty care.
2. Refer patients to collaborative care team professionals as clinically indicated and aligned with patient priorities.
3. Follow best practices for the judicious use of laboratory and other evaluative testing and interventions.
4. Initiate therapeutic interventions that address the personalized antecedents, triggers, and mediators of each patient’s condition and that prioritize diet, lifestyle, gut health, and relief of symptoms.

GOTOIT Functional Medicine Framework



THE INSTITUTE FOR
FUNCTIONAL
MEDICINE®

GOTOIT

The sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine:

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
G – GATHER oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter. Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.	- Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal - Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline	- Use the Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter. - The Adult Intake Form is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the MSQ, PROMIS Questionnaires, and Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information. - Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMs)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the Functional Medicine Timeline.
O – ORGANIZE the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Matrix - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFs) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.
T – TELL the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding. This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory. The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Tree	- The Functional Medicine Timeline is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context. - Use the Functional Medicine Tree to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2025

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
O – ORDER and collaboratively prioritize the most feasible and effective interventions by taking antecedents, triggers, mediators, and patient contextual factors into account.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Readiness for Change - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Integrating Guided Imagery and Visualization to Achieve Personal Health Goals	- Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, co-prioritize the areas of physiological dysfunction. - Assess if the patient is ready and committed to making changes with the Readiness for Change document. Use the Goal Setting for Behavior Change document to determine the patient's goals, values, preferences, and priorities. Then set SMART goals for interventions.
I – INITIATE Initiate interventions based on collaborative prioritization: 1) Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing. 2) Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support. 3) Therapeutic interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan	The Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan helps layout the therapeutic plan. This may include removing or reducing triggers, modifying lifestyle and dietary mediators, addressing gut health and function, implementing other therapeutic interventions, ordering appropriate laboratory tests, or referring as needed.
T – TRACK and monitor the effectiveness of, and adherence to, the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.	- Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	- Use tools to track progress by comparing scores at subsequent visits. The MSQ helps track symptom trajectory, the PROMIS Questionnaires help track overall well-being and quality of life, and the Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal helps track adherence to regimen. - There are many other tools and questionnaires that can be helpful for tracking progress.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2025

Accessible version
available in your toolkit

Long Description

- I F M Toolkit Item: The GO TO IT Framework. Accessible version available in course materials.

Clinical Focus

- Description and elements of the “Initiate” step of the GOTOIT method.
- Referrals as essential interventions.



Clinical Focus

- Description and elements of the “Initiate” step of the GOTOIT method.
- Referrals as essential interventions.



GOTOIT Functional Medicine Framework: INITIATE



GOTOIT

The sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine:

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
G – GATHER oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter. Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.	- Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal - Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline	- Use the Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter. - The Adult Intake Form is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the MSQ, PROMIS Questionnaires, and Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information. - Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMs)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the Functional Medicine Timeline.
O – ORGANIZE the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Matrix - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFs) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.
T – TELL the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding. This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory. The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Tree	- The Functional Medicine Timeline is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context. - Use the Functional Medicine Tree to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8, updated 2025

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
O – ORDER and collaboratively prioritize the most feasible and effective interventions by taking antecedents, triggers, mediators, and patient contextual factors into account.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Readiness for Change - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Integrating Guided Imagery and Visualization to Achieve Personal Health Goals	- Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, co-prioritize the areas of physiological dysfunction. - Assess if the patient is ready and committed to making changes with the Readiness for Change document. Use the Goal Setting for Behavior Change document to determine the patient's goals, values, preferences, and priorities. Then set SMART goals for interventions.
I – INITIATE Initiate interventions based on collaborative prioritization: 1) Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing. 2) Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support. 3) Therapeutic interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan	The Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan helps layout the therapeutic plan. This may include removing or reducing triggers, modifying lifestyle and dietary mediators, addressing gut health and function, implementing other therapeutic interventions, ordering appropriate laboratory tests, or referring as needed.
T – TRACK and monitor the effectiveness of, and adherence to, the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.	- Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	- Use tools to track progress by comparing scores at subsequent visits. The MSQ helps track symptom trajectory, the PROMIS Questionnaires help track overall well-being and quality of life, and the Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal helps track adherence to regimen. - There are many other tools and questionnaires that can be helpful for tracking progress.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8, updated 2025

Accessible version
available in your toolkit

Long Description

- The GO TO IT Framework with emphasis on the INITIATE step.

Initiate

Initiate interventions based upon collaborative prioritization.

Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing.

Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support.

Therapeutic interventions.



Red Flag Clinical Findings: Urgent Referral



GOTOIT

The sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine:

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
G – GATHER oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter. Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.	• Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness • Adult Intake Form • Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) • PROMIS Questionnaires • Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal • Functional Medicine Tree • Functional Medicine Timeline	• Use the Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter. • The Adult Intake Form is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the MSQ, PROMIS Questionnaires, and Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information. • Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMa)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the Functional Medicine Timeline.
O – ORGANIZE the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.	• Functional Medicine Tree • Functional Medicine Timeline • Functional Medicine Matrix • Adult Intake Form • Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) • PROMIS Questionnaires • Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	• Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFa) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.
T – TELL the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding. This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory. The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership.	• Functional Medicine Matrix • Functional Medicine Timeline • Functional Medicine Tree	• The Functional Medicine Timeline is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context. • Use the Functional Medicine Tree to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2025

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
O – ORDER and collaboratively prioritize the most feasible and effective interventions by taking antecedents, triggers, mediators, and patient contextual factors into account.	• Functional Medicine Matrix • Readiness for Change • Goal Setting for Behavior Change • Integrating Guided Imagery and Visualization to Achieve Personal Health Goals	• Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, co-prioritize the areas of physiological dysfunction. • Assess if the patient is ready and committed to making changes with the Readiness for Change document. Use the Goal Setting for Behavior Change document to determine the patient's goals, values, preferences, and priorities. Then set SMART goals for interventions.
I – INITIATE Initiate interventions based on collaborative prioritization: 1) Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing. 2) Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support. 3) Therapeutic interventions.	• Functional Medicine Tree • Functional Medicine Matrix • Functional Medicine Timeline • Goal Setting for Behavior Change • Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan	• The Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan helps layout the therapeutic plan. This may include removing or reducing triggers, modifying lifestyle and dietary referring as needed.
T – TRACK and monitor the effectiveness of, and adherence to, the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.	• Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ) • PROMIS Questionnaires • Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	• Use tools to track progress by comparing scores at subsequent visits. The MSQ helps track symptom trajectory, the PROMIS Questionnaires help track overall well-being and quality of life, and the Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal helps track adherence to regimen. • There are many other tools and questionnaires that can be helpful for tracking progress.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2025

**STOP
and
JUMP TO
IT!**

Long Description

- The GO TO IT Framework with emphasis on the INITIATE step. For red flag clinical findings that warrant an urgent referral, stop and jump to it.

Representative Examples: Red Flags



Identify Red Flags That May Require Urgent Referral:

- Unintended weight loss
- Fever – Altered mental status – Neurological deficit
- Melena, hematochezia, blood per rectum, postmenopausal bleed
- Tachycardia – Dysrhythmia
- Hypotension – Hypertension
- Critical range lab test results

Red Flag Referrals: Existing Guidelines



Examples:

- Primary Care: Interprofessional Collaborative Practice
- Clinical Guidelines in Primary Care
- Nutrition Therapy and Pathophysiology
- An Acupuncturist's Guide to Medical Red Flags and Referrals
- Integrative and Functional Medical Nutrition Therapy: Principles and Practices
- Bright Futures: Guidelines for Health Supervision of Infants, Children, and Adolescents

Red Flag Referrals



Best Practices:

- Clearly communicate rationale for urgency to the patient.
- Promptly communicate with urgent/specialty provider.
- Designate and delegate TRACKING of referral.
- Follow-up communication with patient and provider.

Clinical Findings of “Caution – Care – Consult”: Collaborative Care Team Referrals



GOTOIT

The sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine:

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
G – GATHER oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter. Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.	- Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal - Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline	- Use the Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter. - The Adult Intake Form is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the MSQ, PROMIS Questionnaires, and Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information. - Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMs)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the Functional Medicine Timeline.
O – ORGANIZE the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Matrix - Adult Intake Form - Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFs) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.
T – TELL the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding. This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory. The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Functional Medicine Tree	- The Functional Medicine Timeline is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context. - Use the Functional Medicine Tree to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2023

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
O – ORDER and collaboratively prioritize the most feasible and effective interventions by taking antecedents, triggers, mediators, and patient contextual factors into account.	- Functional Medicine Matrix - Readiness for Change - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Integrating Guided Imagery and Visualization to Achieve Personal Health Goals	- Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, co-prioritize the areas of physiological dysfunction. - Assess if the patient is ready and committed to making changes with the Readiness for Change document. Use the Goal Setting for Behavior Change document to determine the patient's goals, values, preferences, and priorities. Then set SMART goals for interventions.
I – INITIATE Initiate interventions based on collaborative prioritization: 1) Evaluative, diagnostic, and prognostic testing. 2) Referral to another member of the collaborative care team for further assessment, intervention, or support. 3) Therapeutic interventions.	- Functional Medicine Tree - Functional Medicine Matrix - Functional Medicine Timeline - Goal Setting for Behavior Change - Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan	The Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan helps layout the therapeutic plan. This may include removing or reducing triggers, modifying lifestyle and dietary mediators, addressing gut health and function, implementing other therapeutic interventions, ordering appropriate laboratory tests, or referring as needed.
T – TRACK and monitor the effectiveness of, and adherence to, the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.	- Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ) - PROMIS Questionnaires - Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	- Use tools to track progress by comparing scores at subsequent visits. The MSQ helps track symptom trajectory; the PROMIS Questionnaires help track overall well-being and quality of life, and the Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal helps track adherence to regimen. - There are many other tools and questionnaires that can be helpful for tracking progress.

© The Institute for Functional Medicine

Version 8; updated 2023

**Yield and Refer to
Collaborative Care
Team Colleague**

Long Description

- The GO TO IT Framework with emphasis on the INITIATE step. Yield and refer to collaborative care team colleague as appropriate.

The Collaborative Care Team

WHO IS ON YOUR TEAM RIGHT NOW?



Long Description

- Collaborative care team
 - Primary care clinician
 - M D
 - D O
 - N D
 - N P
 - P A
 - Functional and integrative practitioners
 - Medical and surgical specialists
 - Nursing and mental health
 - Nutrition and lifestyle professionals
 - Physical medicine and fitness
 - Health and wellness coach

Caution – Care – Consult Referrals: Representative Examples

- Nutritionist for therapeutic food plans or food eliminations.
- Health coach for lifestyle and behavior change interventions as indicated.
- Pharmacist for medication management, including dose tapering, deprescribing, drug-induced nutrient deficiencies, drug-supplement interactions, and supplement-supplement interactions.

Caution – Care – Consult Referrals: Best Practices

- Clearly communicate rationale for referral to the patient.
- Thorough communication with collaborative provider.
- Predetermined time-bound touch points with provider.
- Follow-up appointment cadence communicated with patient.

Getting Healthy Is a Team Sport



Collaborative Care Teams: Evidence-Based Medicine

- In a study that used a functional medicine model of care and incorporated a multidisciplinary team approach, improvements in patient-reported, health-related quality of life (HRQoL) outcomes were demonstrated.
- Patients in this study met with a clinician, registered dietitian and health coach during their initial visit. They also had access to a behavioral health therapist during their care.

Clinical Focus

- Key IFM Toolkit Asset
- Functional Medicine Prescription & Lifestyle Plan



Initiate IFM Toolkit Items: Educational – Evaluative – Therapeutic



Functional Medicine Matrix

Clinical Imbalances and Physiological Dysfunctions

The Patient's Story

Antecedents
(Inherited & Acquired)

Triggers &
Precipitating Events

Mediators/Perpetuators

Modifiable Lifestyle Factors

Sleep

Physical Activity

Nutrition

Stressors

Relationships

Assimilation

Defense & Repair

Structural Integrity

Mental

Emotional

Spiritual

Communication

Transport

Mitigation & Clearance

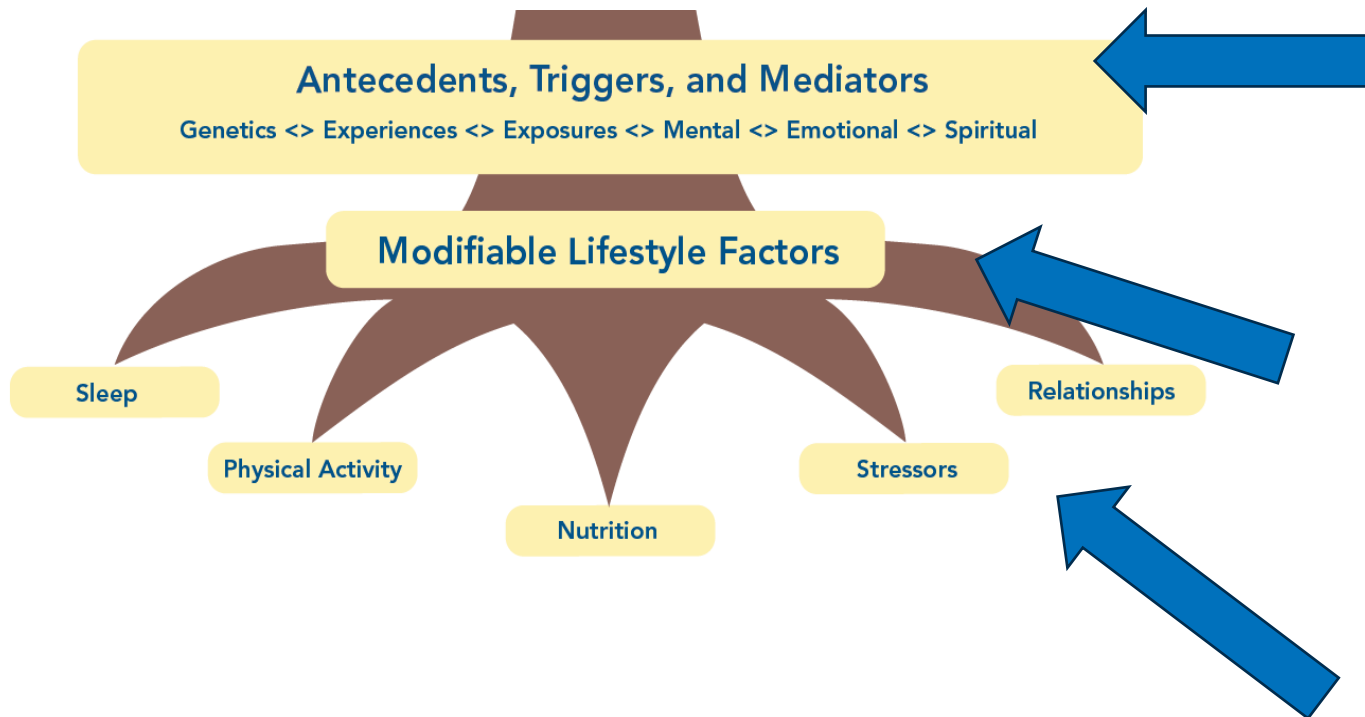
IFM TOOLKIT



Long Description

- Use the I F M toolkit to address the mental, emotional, spiritual, and modifiable lifestyle factors in the functional medicine matrix.

INITIATE STEP: Key IFM Toolkit Item Address the Root Causes



Functional Medicine Prescription & Lifestyle Plan

Patient Name Date of Birth

Functional Nutrition Plan

Foundational Interventions

- ☐ Phytonutrient Spectrum
- ☐ Core Food Plan
- ☐ Vegan
- ☐ Vegetarian

First-Step Interventions

- ☐ Cardiometabolic Food Plan
- ☐ Elimination Diet
- ☐ Food Reintroduction

Advanced Therapeutic Interventions

- ☐ Anti-Candida Food Plan
- ☐ Detox Food Plan
- ☐ Low-FODMAP Food Plan
- ☐ Mito Food Plan

Personal Dietary Recommendations

Macronutrient Distribution (protein/fat/carbs): ☐ 20/30/50 ☐ 25/30/45 ☐ 30/30/40 ☐ 20/60/20

Target Calories: ☐ 1000-1200 ☐ 1200-1400 ☐ 1400-1800 ☐ 1800-2200 ☐ 2200-2500

Intermittent Fasting: ☐ Yes ☐ No Target calories per day: Frequency: times per week

Other Recommendations:

Lifestyle Plan

Sleep

Recommendations:

Exercise

Risk Assessment: ☐ Low Risk ☐ Medium Risk ☐ High Risk

Clearance: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Exercise Prescription:	Cardio/Aerobic	Strength/Resistance	Flexibility/Stretching	Balance
F-Frequency (times per week)				
I-Intensity (e.g., low, moderate, vigorous)				
T-Time/Duration (minutes each day)				
T-Type (walking, jogging, etc.)				

Restoration

- ☐ Self-Awareness/Mindfulness
- ☐ Guided Imagery/Visualization
- ☐ Relaxation Response
- ☐ Breathing Techniques
- ☐ Meditation
- ☐ Other:

Disclaimer: This form is intended to be used within the scope of your practice.

Long Description

- I F M toolkit item: Functional Medicine Prescription and Lifestyle Plan. Accessible version available in course materials.
- Use this toolkit item to address the elements found at the base of the functional medicine tree, including antecedents, triggers, mediators, and modifiable lifestyle factors.

Clinical Focus

- GOTOIT steps and expected clinical outcomes.
- Judicious use of evaluative and laboratory testing.



GATHER patient
story on
TIMELINE

ORGANIZE
patient data on
MATRIX

- Prioritize the physiological dysfunctions

Re-TELL the
patient story

ORDER and
PRIORITIZE

- Patient goals, preferences, circumstances

INITIATE

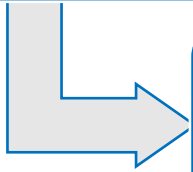
- Remove or reduce TRIGGERS
- Address lifestyle and dietary MEDIATORS
- Address GUT health and function

TRACK

- Subjective and qualitative data
- Patient's circumstances

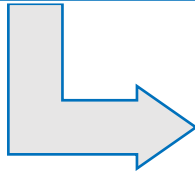
Functional Medicine GOTOIT Clinical Approach Step by Step

GATHER patient
story on
TIMELINE

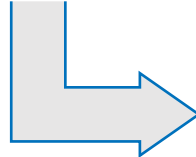


ORGANIZE
patient data on
MATRIX

- **Prioritize the physiological dysfunctions**



Re-TELL the
patient story



Functional Medicine GOTOIT Clinical Approach Step by Step

GATHER patient
story on
TIMELINE

ORGANIZE
patient data on
MATRIX

- Prioritize the physiological dysfunctions

Re-TELL the
patient story

ORDER and
PRIORITIZE

- Patient goals, preferences, circumstances

INITIATE

- Remove or reduce TRIGGERS
- Address lifestyle and dietary MEDIATORS
- Address GUT health and function

Judicious use of
labs and/or
supplements

Functional Medicine GOTOIT
Clinical Approach
Judicious use of lab tests

Long Description

- The functional medicine GO TO IT clinical approach involves the judicious use of labs and/or supplements.

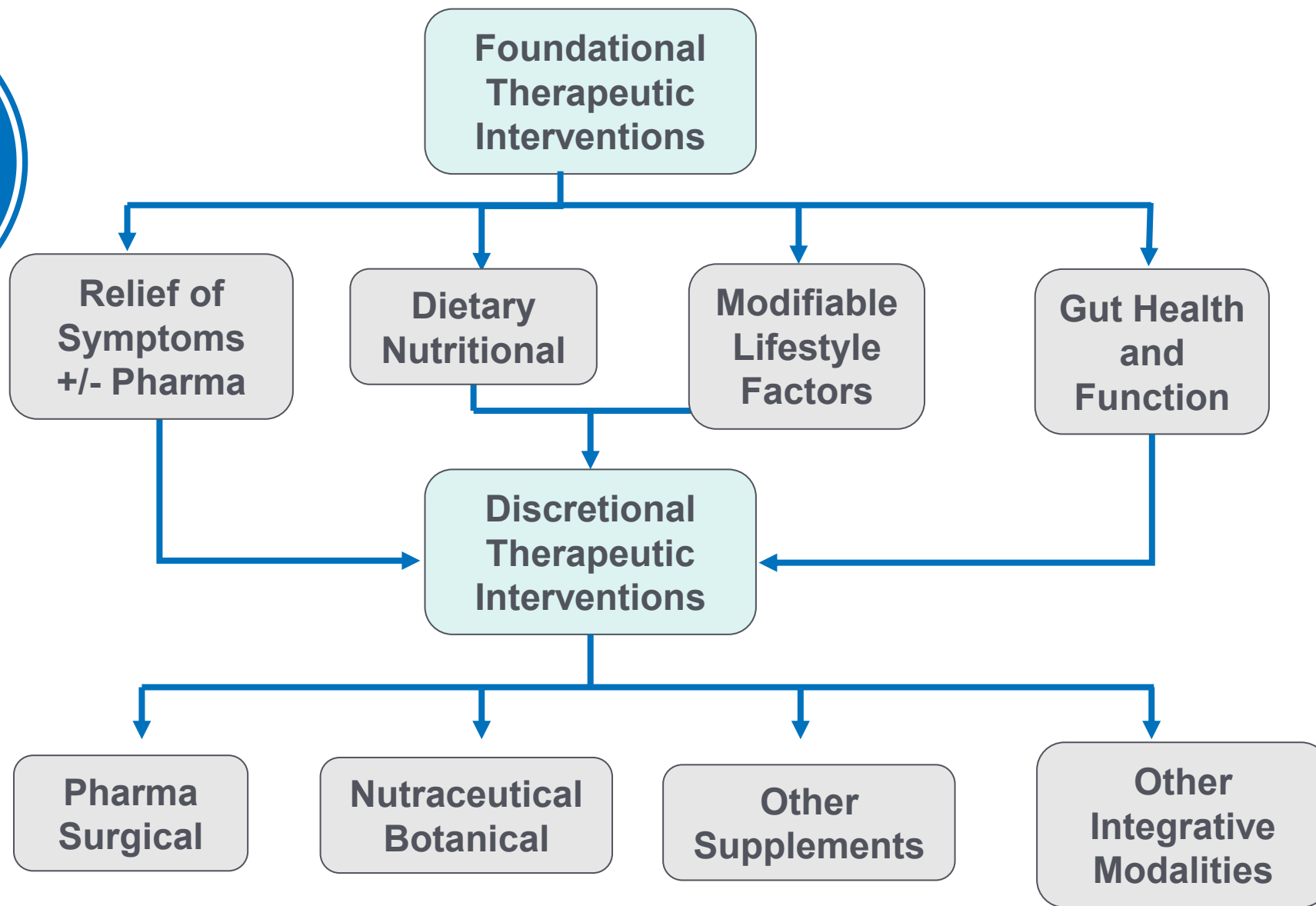
Clinical Focus

- Summary, conclusion, and key clinical takeaways.
- Clinical flow path of the Initiate step of GOTOIT.



**GOTOIT
INITIATE**

**Prioritizing
Therapeutic
Interventions**



Long Description

- Flowpath describing the prioritization of therapeutic interventions. Foundational therapeutic interventions include relief of symptoms with or without pharmaceuticals, addressing nutrition, modifiable lifestyle factors, and gut health. Once these are addressed, discretionary therapeutic interventions such as pharmaceuticals, surgery, nutraceuticals, botanicals, and other supplements and integrative modalities may be considered.

**GOTOIT
INITIATE**

**Prioritizing
Therapeutic
Interventions**

INITIATE:

Team Approach to Foundational Interventions

APPLYING FUNCTIONAL MEDICINE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE